M/J Visual Art 2

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · COURSE SYLLABUS · 2026–2027

Full Year · Grade 7

FACILITATOR
[Teacher Name]

EMAIL & OFFICE
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FLORIDA COURSE
Florida 0101110 · Full-year course

OFFICE HOURS
[Office hours — days & times]

GRADE LEVEL
Grade 7 (Middle School)

FORMAT
On-Demand (also offered as a live section)

About this syllabus. This is the plan for the course as designed. It is a full-year, grade 7 art course; On-Demand scholars pace through the seventeen two-week studio modules across the four quarters of their enrolled year. On-Demand and live-school sections share the same content and expectations; exact pacing, scheduled dates, and a few activities may vary from section to section and term to term. Your facilitator will confirm the specifics for your section.

COURSE OVERVIEW

M/J Visual Art 2 continues the study of the seven Elements of Art and the Principles of Design begun in Visual Art 1, and adds a chronological survey of art history. Scholars move module by module from the illuminated manuscripts of the medieval scriptorium through the Italian Renaissance, the Baroque, Realism, and Pop Art in the fall, then from digital art and Impressionism through Post-Impressionism, Pop Art, color theory, Surrealism, Fauvism, and Expressionism in the spring, closing with a sculpture and exhibit-design capstone. Each two-week module pairs a short study or master-copy sketch of a real artwork with an original studio artwork and a written artist statement, so the scholar practices both looking closely and making with intention.

WHAT SCHOLARS WILL LEARN TO DO

- Apply the seven Elements of Art and Principles of Design deliberately in original studio work, building on Visual Art 1.
- Study a chronological survey of art history and movements, from medieval illuminated manuscripts through the Renaissance, Baroque, Realism, Impressionism, Post-Impressionism, Pop Art, Surrealism, Fauvism, and Expressionism.
- Practice a two-week studio rhythm: a Week 1 master-study sketch that copies a real artwork, and a Week 2 original artwork with a written artist statement.
- Use accurate art vocabulary to discuss and analyze artworks, including a real featured masterwork in every module.
- Build skill with value, texture, color, and composition across a range of media, including drawing, paint, collage, and simple sculpture.
- Reflect on personal artistic choices in writing and build a portfolio of finished work across the year, closing with a sculpture and exhibit-design capstone.

BIG PROJECTS & MILESTONES

The course builds toward a set of finished, real-world artifacts. Target dates below follow a **sample full-year pacing**; On-Demand scholars pace to their own enrolled term and Live sections follow the class schedule, keeping each milestone roughly in order.

PROJECT / MILESTONE	COURSE PLACE	SAMPLE TARGET	WHAT YOU TURN IN
Elements of Art Drawing	Module 1 · Weeks 1–2	by Aug 26	A master-study sketch of a featured artwork plus an original drawing using all seven Elements of Art on purpose.
Illuminated Manuscript Letter	Module 2 · Weeks 3–4	by Sep 9	A decorated letter designed with pattern, color, and symbol in the medieval illuminated-manuscript tradition.
City Drawing in One-Point Perspective	Module 3 · Weeks 5–6	by Sep 23	An original city scene built with a vanishing point and one-point linear perspective.
Value Pumpkins	Module 5 · Weeks 9–10	by Oct 30	One to three pumpkins or gourds shaded through a full range of value, from highlight to cast shadow, in the manner of Baroque light and shadow.
Still Life (Realism)	Module 7 · Weeks 13–14	by Dec 4	An observational still-life drawing using value and true-to-life proportion, with an artist statement connecting the work to Realism.
Art Through Time: Transforming Images	Module 9 · Weeks 17–18	by Jan 22	A reinterpretation of a historical artwork using digital tools, with a short reflection on technology's role in the visual arts.
Color Wheel Eye	Module 13 · Weeks 25–26	by Apr 9	An original twelve-color wheel design applied to an eye illustration, showing accurate color mixing and relationships.
3D Mini Gallery: Your Year in Review (Capstone)	Module 17 · Weeks 33–34	by May 28 (Q4 end)	A curated 3D mini gallery of the year's strongest work with an artist statement, closing the year's studio and art-history survey.

IMPORTANT DATES — 2026–2027

Aug 12, 2026	First day of school	**Sep 7**	Holiday (Labor Day)
Oct 9	Quarter 1 ends	**Oct 12**	Holiday (Columbus Day)
Nov 11	Holiday (Veterans' Day)	**Nov 23–27**	Thanksgiving break
Dec 18	Quarter 2 ends · fall semester ends	**Dec 21–Jan 1**	Winter break
Jan 5, 2027	Classes resume	**Jan 18**	Holiday (MLK Day)
Feb 15	Holiday (Presidents' Day)	**Mar 5**	Quarter 3 ends
Mar 26–Apr 5	Spring break	**Apr 6**	Classes resume
May 28, 2027	Quarter 4 ends · last day of school	**May 31**	Holiday (Memorial Day)

ASSESSMENT & GRADING

100 pts
Week 2 Studio Artwork & Artist Statement, each module (rubric-graded)

20 pts
Community Discussion, each module

10 pts
Week 1 Sketch / Master Study, each module (completion)

Auto-graded
Week 1 Quiz (Elements/Principles or Art History), each module

HOW THIS COURSE IS DELIVERED

This course is offered in two formats that share the same content, assignments, and expectations: an **On-Demand (asynchronous)** section you pace yourself, and a **Live (synchronous)** section that meets on a schedule on Optima's VR campus. The two overviews below explain how each one works. Find the one that matches your enrollment.

ON-DEMAND (ASYNCHRONOUS) LEARNING

In the **On-Demand** section you move through the course at your own pace within each quarter, guided by due dates that keep you on track. All assignments for a quarter open at its start and close at its end. Because the course is On-Demand, there is no grade penalty for missing an individual due date — but any assignment not completed by the end of the quarter receives a **zero**, and assignments submitted in the final **14 days** of a quarter receive a **10% deduction**, so steady pacing matters.

Attendance is measured by assignment completion. Per school policy, a scholar who completes no assignment for ten consecutive school days, without notifying the school of an absence in advance, may be dropped from the course. Completion means a **sincere attempt** — real effort on real work. Rushed work, wrong or corrupted files, irrelevant or nonsense submissions, AI-generated filler, and word-salad responses do not count.

You are never on your own. A live facilitator grades your work, gives feedback, and hosts a weekly study hall and VR workshops.

LIVE (SYNCHRONOUS) LEARNING

In the **Live** section you join scheduled class meetings on Optima's VR campus, where your teacher leads instruction in real time and you learn alongside classmates. The readings, assignments, and projects are the same as the On-Demand course; what differs is the pacing — a Live section moves through the material together on the class schedule rather than at each scholar's own pace, and class time is also used for discussion, questions, and guided practice.

Attendance is measured by presence and participation. You are expected to attend the scheduled live sessions, on time and ready to take part. If you must miss a class, notify the school in advance; your teacher will let you know how to make up the work and any material you missed. As in every Optima course, completing your work means a **sincere attempt** — real effort on real work — and assignments still open and close with each quarter.

You meet regularly with a teacher. The class gathers throughout the week in VR and on Microsoft Teams for live instruction and discussion.

APPROPRIATE USE OF AI

Optima scholars are preparing for a world shaped by artificial intelligence, and learning to use these tools with good judgment is part of that preparation. You are welcome to use AI tools to **support** your learning — to explain a concept a different way, check your understanding, or brainstorm — unless a particular assignment says otherwise. What AI may **never** do is the thinking or the work an assignment asks of you: a reflection, a self-assessment, a resume, an essay, or a discussion post must be genuinely your own. Submitting AI-generated text as if it were your own work is dishonest and, as noted above, counts as an insincere attempt. When you do use an AI tool on an assignment, say so briefly. Above all, build the underlying skill yourself — the goal is for you to be able to judge whether an AI's answer is any good, which you can only do if you can do the work without it.

LEARNING IN VIRTUAL REALITY

Optima is a virtual-reality school. Alongside your Canvas coursework, you will join immersive sessions on Optima's VR campus, where you meet teachers and fellow scholars, take part in live activities, and explore places and ideas you could not visit in an ordinary classroom. Keep your headset charged and ready for any scheduled VR sessions, and treat the VR campus with the same courtesy and seriousness you would a physical one. If you ever cannot get into VR for a session, tell your facilitator — there is an alternative way to take part so you do not fall behind.

BEING AN OPTIMA SCHOLAR

Optima's mission is an excellent, virtue-centered education, and virtue is at the center of this course as much as any other. Every scholar is expected to practice the seven virtues that shape life at Optima — **courage, courtesy, honesty, perseverance, self-government, service, and responsibility**. In practice that means: do your own honest work; treat everyone you meet in, through, or because of this course with respect, in writing, in discussion, and in VR; engage actively rather than passively; come to office hours to get help, meet other scholars, and get to know your facilitator; and take responsibility for your own pacing and progress. You belong to a house and a community of scholars, not only to a course.

WHAT YOU NEED & STAYING CONNECTED

- A computer with reliable internet and access to **Canvas**.
- Basic drawing supplies: a pencil and eraser, and any paper (printer paper is fine); a ruler for the perspective and geometric units.
- **Color media**: a fine-liner or marker for outlining, plus paint or markers for building color and value.
- **Microsoft 365** (Word) with OneDrive, for artist statements and the digital portfolio of photographed artwork you build across the year.
- A phone or camera to photograph or scan finished artwork for submission.

Staying connected. Updates about this course are posted on the course's **Canvas** page; school-wide updates are posted in your **Homeroom Canvas** course. Check both regularly. Your facilitator holds office hours and is glad to help with the material, to meet you, or to talk through your plans — come by, or reach out any time by email.

M/J Visual Art 2 · Florida course 0101110 · Full-year, grade 7 studio-art course · Optima Academy Online, 2026–2027. Built from the Semester 1 and Semester 2 course build (17 two-week modules) and the board-approved 2026–2027 academic calendar. Project target dates reflect a sample full-year pacing; On-Demand scholars pace to their own enrolled term. School calendar dates may be adjusted by the school.